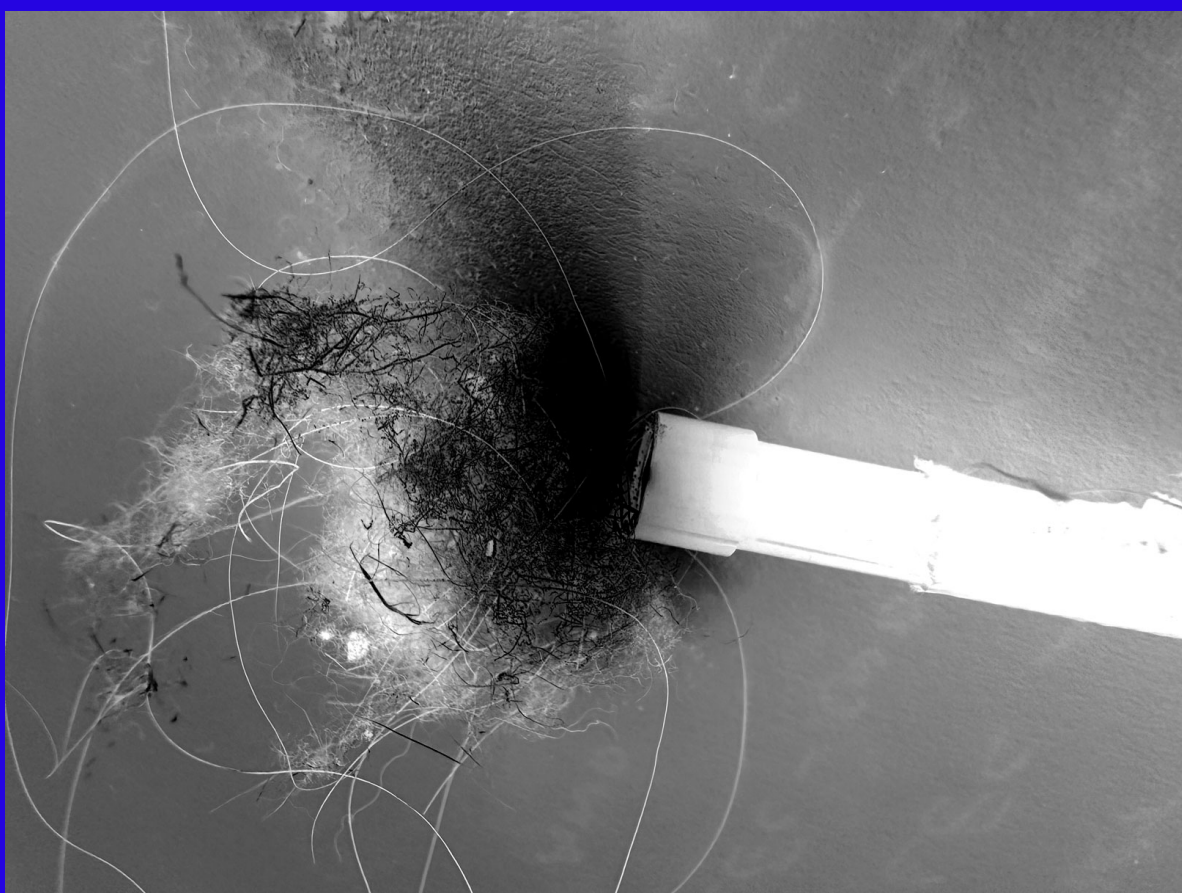


An Interview with Dust

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Final Code-Project
By Aous Hamoud
Summer Term - 2026

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GitHub Repo <https://github.com/justanothersquirrel/An-Interview-with-Dust>

GitHub deploy <https://justanothersquirrel.github.io/An-Interview-with-Dust/>

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Performance video of one of an interview

<https://youtu.be/YfQEC5fSJrM?si=KO75K-J5RiWdh4WN>

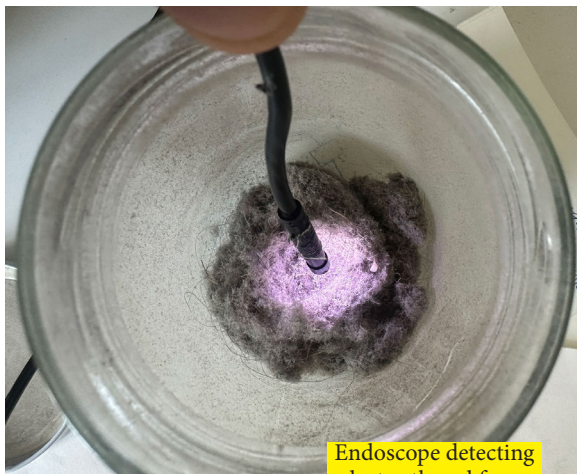
Introduction

"An Interview with Dust" is a code project built to elaborate an act of investigation with dust as part of Amorphous Research. Performing the investigation with the endoscope and audio triggering has established a condition of communication and experimentation with found objects (dirt and thrown-away items), dust from the vacuum machine, and the Temple of the Sun, a rock from a Roman temple in Lebanon.

The experiment illuminates an interview with dust, giving this matter the stage and opportunity to explain and elaborate its existence. This audio and visual participation has made available close, awakened, and random engagement with abandoned, fallen, unnoticed objects... This is an unfinished experiment.



Image of Temple of Sun rock



Endoscope detecting dust gathered from vacuum

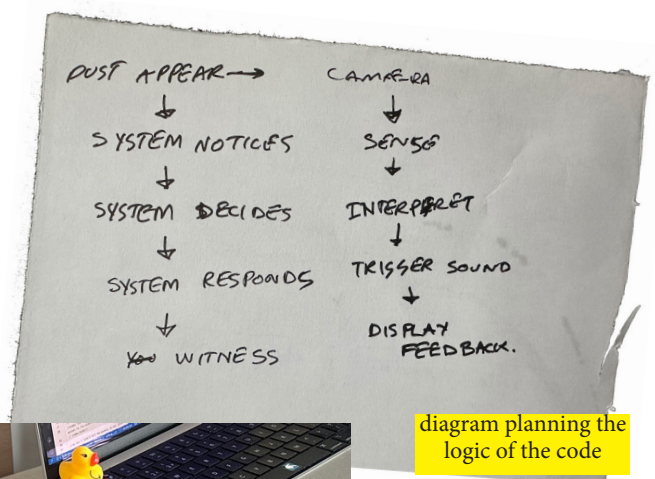


diagram planning the logic of the code



Setting up the interview with endoscope connected to laptop and dust collected in jars

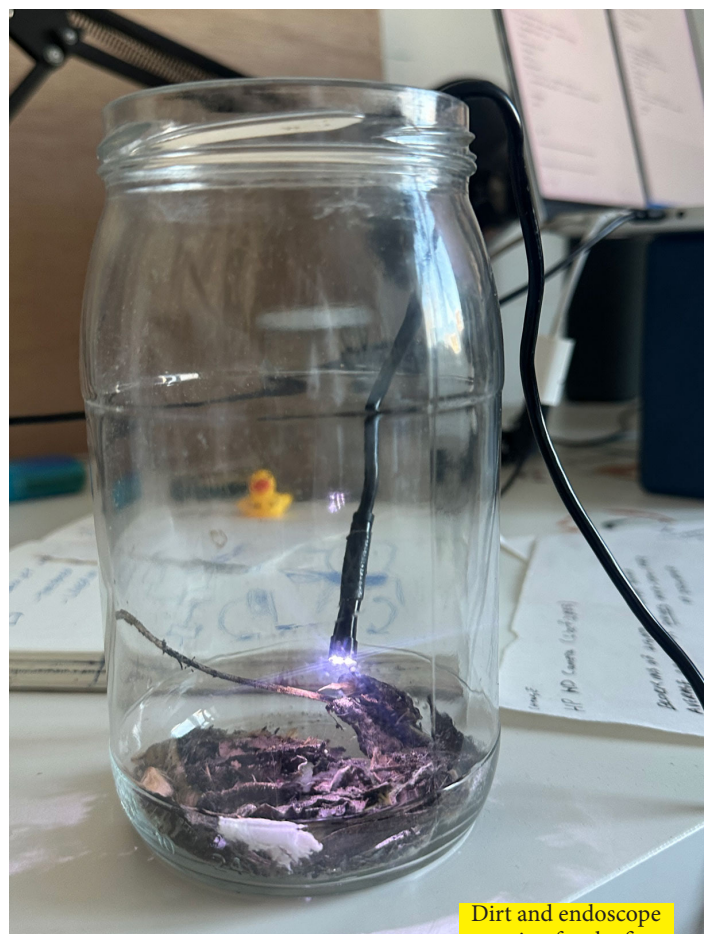
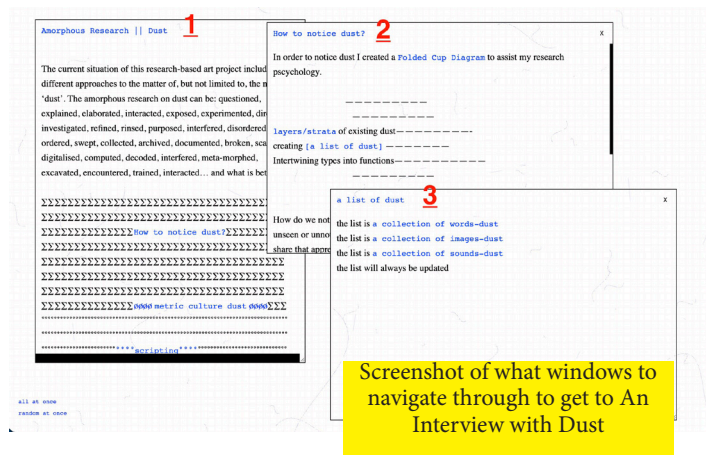
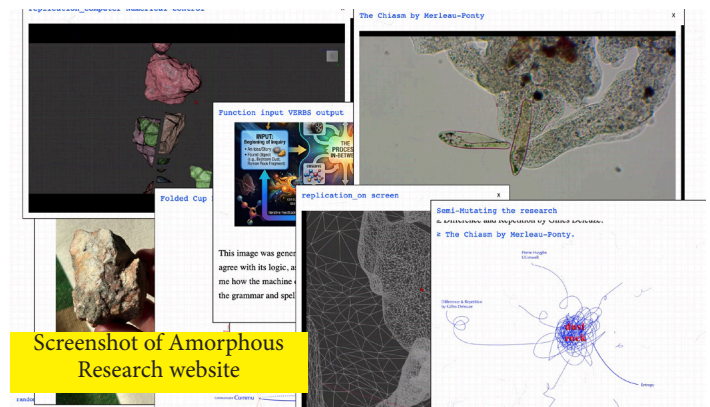
Background_

This experiment is an extension to an ongoing “Amorphous Research” project on noticing dust. The current situation of this research-based art project includes different approaches to notions including, but not limited to, ‘dust’. The amorphous research on dust can be: questioned, explained, elaborated, interacted, exposed, experimented, directed, investigated, refined, rinsed, purposed, interfered, disordered, ordered, swept, collected, archived, documented, broken, scanned, digitalised, computed, decoded, interfered, meta-morphed, excavated, encountered, trained, interacted... and what is between.

The performance tool can be used publicly to communicate information about the research process of ‘Amorphous Research,’ and personally to help research dust through artistic, computable intervention. I have had a plumber’s endoscope for a while and have used it for several performances and installations. Other than my research on the notion of dust, I am interested in the act of reusing this tool and repurposing its means for artistic ends—from being an inspection camera used in inaccessible areas in plumbing, drains, and automotive, to becoming a research investigative tool to approach unreachable subject matter.

In Amorphous Research, there is a layer where I began to collect data about dust, creating an abstract archive that frames objects, sounds, and words within the notion of dust. Framing objects using the camera, framing words by finding different titles in relation to dust, and framing sound by using the endoscope. This experiment will extend to reach my memories by using my audio diaries, looking at them as thoughts, and adding frequencies in which both can be amplified and initiated by the pixels in the video inputs of the endoscope.

There are many artists related to the dust research, but for this specific code project, I have been inspired by the artist Martin Howse (Howse, 2026); his approach to earth and computers inspires this project in conditioning the performance of and creating an intention of harmony between the viewer and the abstraction of dust.



Technincal Development

Phase one

Examining Foundation Code

The foundational elements that were used as an initiation for *An Interview with Dust* was reading *Sound_Camera_Theremin* and I have used pixel use with nested loop, and pixel jump, and transformed oscillator to audio library.

Phase Two [Link to video](#)

Swapping the built-in webcam with endoscope to allow intimate physical interaction with dust.

Phase Three [Link to video](#)

Aligning the code with the research

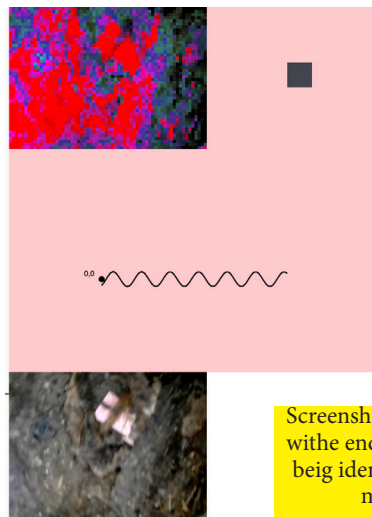
Replacing oscillator synth with audio diaries form my recording library.

Exchanged pixel sampling loop to more complex objective, by initiating the code to scan for RGB value, Motion, and spatial position. This complex created a chaotic output where I couldn't recognise if the dust dialogue was intentional happening or just a noise of audio assets playing randomly.

Phase Four [Link to video](#)

Simplifying the code

Changing the logic from pixels data choosing audio assets constantly to more specified encounters yet keeping the randomness of choice. Then it would control when track would play, pause, or loop by state management, forcing the code to wait a specific amount of time before changing tracks according to RGB and motion.



Screenshot of Theremin code with endoscope - Red Pixels being identified as brightness measurement

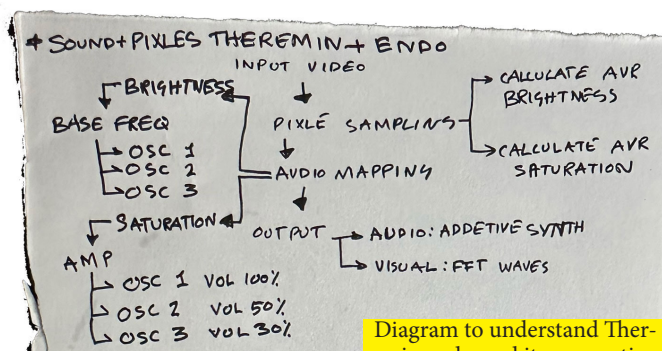


Diagram to understand Theremin code, and its connection with endoscope.

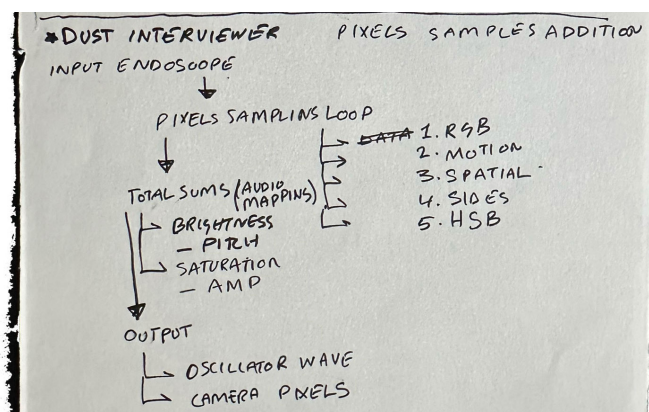
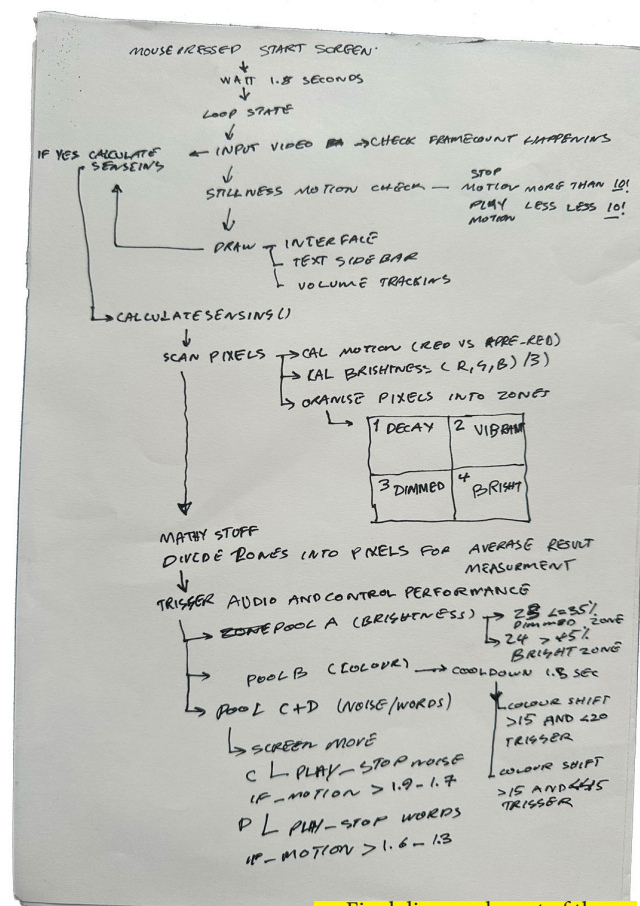


diagram mapping out different commands to interact for the output.



Final diagram layout of the code-project.

Phase Five_ Specifying the code

I deleted the global variables and created a specified zone system on the screen to branch the audio pools into detailed conceptual sections.

RGB ZONES

Zone-01 detects grey shades => triggers audio 18-23 [Decay Dust Zone]

Zone-02 detects colours => trigger tracks 24 -27 [Vibrant Dust Zone]

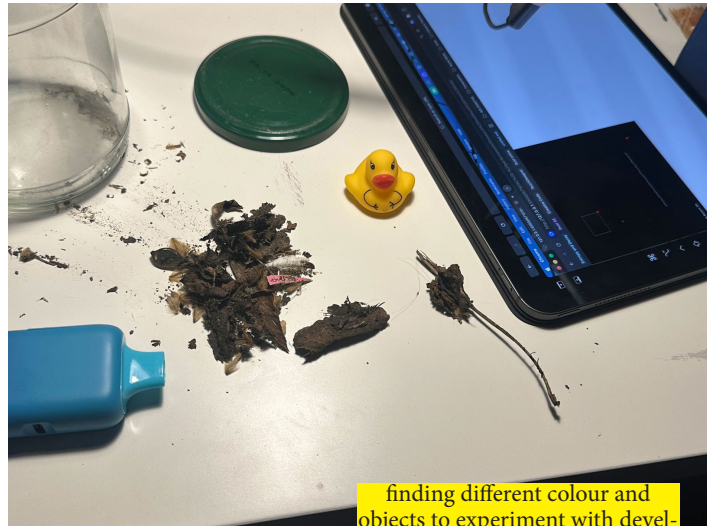
BRIGHTNESS ZONE

Zone-03 detects brightness between 0% - 35% => triggers audio 0-8 [Dimmed Dust Zone]

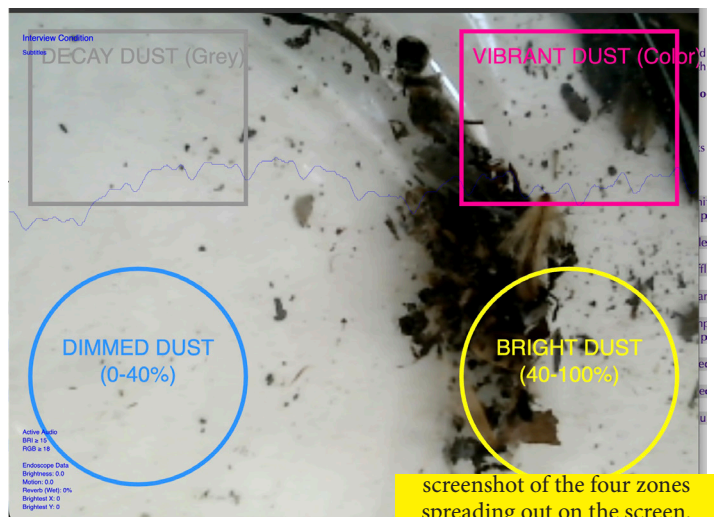
Zone-04 detects brightness between 45% - 100% => triggers audio 9-17 [Bright Dust Zone]

Phase Six_ Adding motion

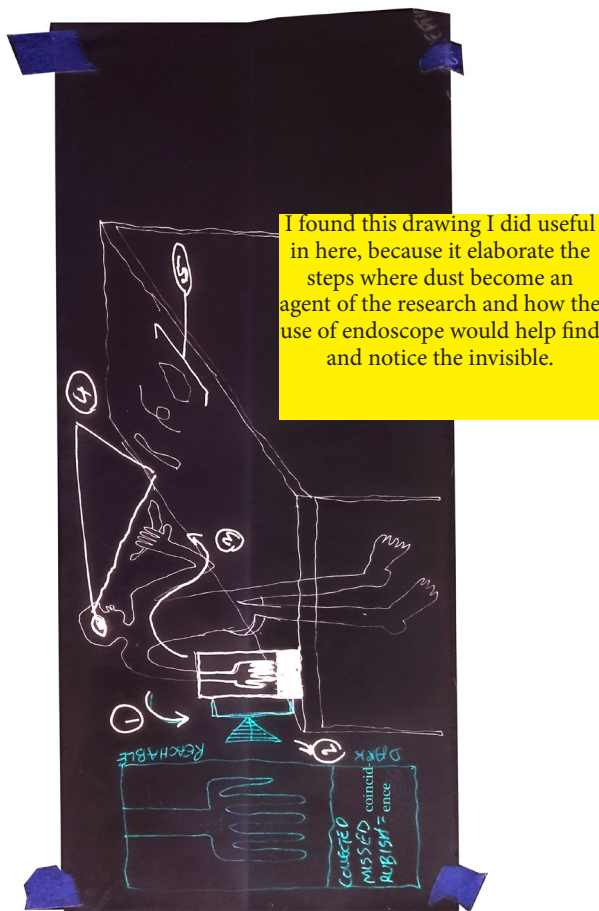
This addition, adapts the code-project with Amorphous Research, with inverted stillness command, the motion has added a more independent feeling to audio interaction with the endoscope inout. The final audio tracks became 44, adding a layer of noise and words triggered by the movement of the endoscope.



finding different colour and objects to experiment with developing the code



screenshot of the four zones spreading out on the screen.



I found this drawing I did useful in here, because it elaborate the steps where dust become an agent of the research and how the use of endoscope would help find and notice the invisible.

Reflection and further developments_

While making this code, many thoughts have sparked on how to develop this tool. The code is programmed to identify pixels; dust is never identified, as everything in the video input is identified. What creates the connection is simply that any motion that enters the frame will ignite an audio asset. I am happy with the outcome, but because it is an investigation into the unknown, I aim to decrease the abstraction of the tool toward dust. With my research growing, I notice that I am building an archive of information which I want to use as data to support the tool's engagement with dust. I'm getting more interested in the manual text input of data with JSON, audio assets, and computer vision.

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